

on either of the three platforms. The professional-grade solution Geekbench Pro comes with command-line tools and a standalone mode, allowing you to utilise the programme professionally.

6. MSI Afterburner

Anyone who wants to overclock their graphics card should have MSI Afterburner. Although it is entirely GPU-centric and does not support CPUs, the level of control it offers is what makes it truly remarkable.

Any GPU can be used with MSI Afterburner, regardless of the manufacturer. It not only provides comprehensive technical details for your graphics card but also complete control over your GPU, including settings for fan speed, voltage, and clock speed. An FPS counter that allows you to track your GPU performance in real time is also included in the app.

A free tool is MSI Afterburner. It is the only tool you will require if you're looking for industry-standard software to safely overclock your GPU.

How can benchmarking software help?

1. **Performance testing:** Benchmarking software allows you to test the performance of your computer hardware, such as the CPU, GPU, and RAM. This can help you determine whether your hardware is performing as expected or whether it needs to be upgraded.
2. **Hardware comparison:** Benchmarking software can be used to compare the performance of different hardware components or computers. This can be helpful when making purchasing decisions or when trying to optimize performance.
3. **Optimization:** Benchmarking software can help you identify areas where you can optimize your hardware performance, such as by adjusting settings or upgrading components.
4. **Stability testing:** Benchmarking software can also be used for stability testing. This involves running stress tests on your hardware to ensure that it is stable and can handle heavy workloads without crashing or overheating.
5. **Gaming performance:** Benchmarking software can be particularly useful for gamers, as it allows them to test the performance of their hardware when running games. This can help them identify areas where they can optimize their hardware to get better gaming performance.
6. **Overclocking:** Benchmarking software can be used to test the performance of your hardware when overclocked. Overclocking involves running hardware components at higher

speeds than they were designed for, and benchmarking software can help you determine the optimal overclocking settings for your hardware.

What to keep in mind when using benchmarking software?

When using benchmarking software, it's important to keep the following things in mind:

1. **System stability:** Running benchmark tests can be stressful on your hardware, so it's important to ensure that your system is stable before running tests. This can include making sure that your hardware is in good working condition and that your system is free of malware or other issues that could affect test results.
2. **Accurate test conditions:** To get accurate results, it's important to run benchmark tests under the same conditions each time. This can include using the same hardware and software settings, running tests in a controlled environment, and avoiding other activities that could affect test results.
3. **Understanding limitations:** Benchmark tests can be useful, but it's important to understand their limitations. Benchmarks can only provide information about the specific hardware and software configurations used in the test, and may not accurately represent real-world performance.
4. **Interpreting results:** When interpreting benchmark results, it's important to understand what the results mean and how they compare to other systems or hardware configurations. It's also important to understand that benchmark results may not provide a complete picture of overall system performance.
5. **Security:** When downloading benchmarking software, it's important to ensure that the software is legitimate and safe to use. This can include checking the software publisher, reading user reviews, and using reputable download sources.
6. **Overclocking risks:** Overclocking hardware can lead to improved performance, but it also carries some risks. Overclocking can cause hardware damage or instability, so it's important to understand the risks and follow safe overclocking practices.

In summary, using benchmarking software can be a useful tool for evaluating hardware performance, but it's important to keep in mind system stability, accurate test conditions, understanding limitations, interpreting results, security, and overclocking risks. By following these guidelines, users can ensure that they get accurate and useful results from benchmark tests. 